

On ethical leadership 論合乎道德倫理的領導管理

Why this new and emerging interest in ethical leadership?

This is how I look at it. As we are intently watching the global markets, both Fortune 500 and Inc 500 companies continue to look at China and India as the key major mega markets where opportunities for market expansion are vibrantly increasing in different corners. On the other hand, Chinese businesses are also eyeing more aggressively companies overseas in North America and Europe.

Looking back, while hospitality is still a key component of doing business in Asia, the historical way of doing business has changed from the past where companies relied heavily upon relationships (Guanxi) and facilitation where budgets appear to be modest. Moving forward, the focus has shifted to more stern corporate transparency requirements, dual listings, more special audits and independent overseers – thus stirring up a sharp demand for more ethical leadership not only in China but also in the global business environment.

With recent notable leadership practice challenges in Malaysia, the Philippines, South Korea, Brazil and Taiwan, it's becoming more evident that both country and corporate leadership must become more principled and ethical if business sustainability and change are to be achieved. The recent cases of Volkswagen and Mitsubishi erring in corporate and consumer disclosures clearly reveals that the challenge has pervaded not only in China but in the global arena as well.

How will these affect management education?

Foremost, let's understand that China has made education a national priority. Almost every week a new university opens its doors in China. Equally sobering and compelling is that at least 40% of the world's engineering and technical graduates are minted each year in China and by 2020 it is expected to be around 60%. The implication of such significant upsurge of graduates is so compelling given the fact that the number of patents filed each year on the mainland has

been growing dramatically over the last eight years.

More than ever, Management and Business degree programs must be relevant and practical, since the library of congress now almost doubles itself every four years. Towards that end, it's even more important that graduate business education must be taught by leading practitioners together with experienced faculty. In recent years, many EMBA programs have come under heavy criticism as many participants have been enrolling for the purpose of networking and for future access. Needless to say, this is unfair, if not awkward. This motive has not considered the many benefits participants may have enjoyed and that they may have eventually applied whatever significant learning they would gain in building business development initiatives and facilitating business from Hong Kong to Shanghai to Singapore along with many other key cities in the region.

Thus, that leading EMBA and DBA programs need to be responsive to market needs and conditions has become more of a compelling necessity than a mere option in management education. As the demands grow, emerging special programs such as Conflict Management, Business and Behaviour, Global Trends and Social Network Theory will definitely emerge. As such, learning for all of us has no other option than to be perpetual and lifelong.

Leadership education obviously is not effective if attended once every 20 years. Study of leadership should not be restricted to a discussion about the latest fads and models but must go deeper into the anatomy of leadership coupled with a profound understanding of Behavioural Science. All too often, leaders today are promoted within corporations not because of their innovative or motivational abilities and skills but because of their politically savvy and manoeuvring. To answer the question, these last few years the impact on teaching has in fact been dramatic with more than 50,000 published theories released. In the present teaching era where competition is getting tougher every day and there are unavoidable economic changes, education is imperative. Moreover, what strikes the balance between chaos and functioning is leadership.



人們為何會對合乎道德倫理的領導管理這新思維感興趣？

我的個人看法是，我們關注全球市場發展的同時，財富500強及Inc 500強企業均視中國和印度兩大市場為商務擴展的重點，並大力在各領域進行投資。另一方面，中國企業亦更積極地瞄準並投資北美及歐洲等地的企業。

雖然人脈仍是在亞洲營商的重要元素，但企業過往以關係為主導的方式——那是從前預算額有限的年代——已經起了變化。展望將來，重點將轉移至更嚴格的企業透明度要求、兩地上市、專業審計和獨立監督等，意味在中國乃至全球商業生態中，合乎道德倫理的領導管理將逐漸變成常態。

馬來西亞、菲律賓、南韓、巴西及台灣最近均出現針對政治領導人的挑戰。這證明要實現企業可持續發展和變革，國家及企業領導管理均須朝著合乎道德倫理的方向發展。大眾和三菱等企業最近備受醜聞困擾，顯示問題不僅存在於中國，亦存在於全球其他地區。

這對管理教育將構成甚麼影響？

首先，我們要知道，中國將教育視為國策的重中之重。中國幾乎每個星期就迎來一所新的大學，而同樣引人注目的是，全球至少40%的工程及技術系畢業生，都是中國培育的；到了2020年，比例將進一步上升至近60%。畢業生人數激增的同時，最近8年間在中國提交的專利申請數目亦大幅上升。

現時，國會圖書館的藏書數量，每隔4年就翻倍，而商業管理等課程的相關性與實際性，就更是必須。更重要的是，學位後商業管理課程須由有經驗的實踐型專家任教。近年來，不少高級工商管理碩士課程因淪為學員擴展網絡的台階，而飽受批評。這無疑是不公平的，也是令人尷尬的——這是忽略了學員獲得的不少益處。學員最終可能會學以致用，在香港、上海、新加坡乃至本地區其他主要城市促進商務發展。

因此，頂尖的高級工商管理碩士課程及工商管理博士課程，需迎合市場環境及需要。對管理教育而言，這並不是選擇，而是有迫切的需要。隨著需求增長，衝突管理、商業與行為、全球趨勢及社會網絡理論等新興專業課程將應運而生。對所有人而言，這意味著除終身學習外，並無其它選擇。